



Medford City Council
Medford, Massachusetts

The Fourteenth Regular Meeting August 4th, 2026

This meeting took place in the City Council Chamber, 2nd Floor, Medford City Hall, 85 George P. Hassett Drive, Medford, MA and via Zoom. To submit written comments, please email REliseo@medford-ma.gov.

CALL TO ORDER

President Zac Bears called the Fourteenth Regular Meeting of the Medford City Council to order in the Council Chambers and via Zoom.

ROLL CALL

Present: President Bears; Vice President Lazzaro; Councilor Callahan; Councilor Leming; Councilor Mullane; Councilor Scarpelli; Councilor Tseng. Seven members were present and no members were absent. Inside the Rail: Acting City Clerk Richard Eliseo Jr.

SALUTE TO THE FLAG

ANNOUNCEMENTS, ACCOLADES, REMEMBRANCES, REPORTS, AND RECORDS

26-135 - Resolution in Remembrance of John Westwater

Whereas, John Westwater lived on Usher Road, steps from the West Medford train station. He taught middle school at St. Joseph's in Medford for many years, where his affectionate nickname was "Mister Sister." His favorite hobbies were camping and going for walks. He loved nature, his home, and his neighborhood; and,

Whereas, on July 20th an Amtrak train was passing through the West Medford train station, just down the street from where John lived. He was crossing the tracks and was hit. John died from his injuries. He was 77 years old; now, therefore:

Be It Resolved by the Medford City Council that we share our deepest condolences with Mr. Westwater's family and loved ones and express our hope that this senseless tragedy will not be in vain and will not be repeated.

Be it Further Resolved that we will work with the Massachusetts Bay Transit Authority and Amtrak, a quasi-governmental corporation created by Congress in 1970 to preserve intercity passenger rail service, to make sorely needed safety improvements to the West Medford commuter and Amtrak train station so this will never happen again.

Vice President Lazzaro Motioned to approve (seconded by Councilor Tseng) –
Approved on a Roll call vote of Seven in favor, Zero opposed

Councilor Tseng motioned to Approve Joining the Records and Reports together (seconded by Councilor Mullane) – Approved on a Roll call vote of Seven in favor, Zero opposed

The Records of the Meeting of June 23, 2026, were passed to Vice President Lazzaro, who found them in order

The Records of the Meeting of July 14, 2026, were passed to Councilor Leming who found them in order

19-070 - Committee of the Whole, July 14, 2026, Report Overview by President Bears

26-031 - Public Health and Community Safety Committee, July 15, 2026, Report Overview by Vice President Lazzaro

Councilor Tseng motioned to Approve Joining the Records and Reports together (seconded by Councilor Mullane) – Approved on a Roll call vote of Seven in favor, Zero opposed

Refer to Committee for Further Discussion

26-138 - Resolution to Update the Noise Ordinance (to be referred to Resident Services Committee)

Whereas, the City of Medford’s Noise Ordinance was last updated in 1974, and is lacking any recent updates to types of noise that can impact residents; and

Whereas, residents of Medford have shared a variety of ways in which different noise levels have been impacting their daily lives; and

Whereas, noise levels can also be considered a health hazard, and it is left to the community to help regulate and advise on noise restrictions throughout their city and towns; and

Whereas, the American Public Health Association has stated that “loud noise causes hearing loss and tinnitus and can contribute to non-auditory health problems. Chronic noise, even at low levels, can cause annoyance, sleep disruption, and stress that contribute to cardiovascular disease, cerebrovascular disease, metabolic disturbances, exacerbation of psychological disorders, and premature mortality. Noise interferes with cognition and learning, contributes to behavior problems, and reduces achievement and productivity. The health of more than 100 million Americans is at risk, with children among the most vulnerable.”; and

Whereas, “The APHA policy statements below relate to this update by advocating for the following: reducing environmental stressors and their harmful effects on public health, rectifying the disproportionate burden of environmental hazards borne by disadvantaged populations, and encouraging actions to mitigate adverse effects. Including noise as a stressor in future APHA policy statements and updates is recommended.”

Be it Resolved by the Medford City Council that the Council's Resident Services and Public Engagement Committee review the current noise ordinance to update its language, function, type and current usage.

Councilor Mullane motioned to approve and refer 26-138 out to committee (seconded by Councilor Tseng) – Approved on a Roll call vote of Seven in favor, Zero opposed

SUSPENSION OF THE RULES

Councilor Callahan motioned to suspend the rules and take papers 26-143, 26-144 and 26-145 out of Order (Seconded by VP Lazzaro) – Motion Approved on a Roll call vote of Sven in favor, Zero opposed

COMMUNICATIONS FROM CITY OFFICERS AND EMPLOYEES

26-143 - Relocation of Polling Place - Ward 4, Precinct 2



City of Medford

*Election Commission
85 George P. Hassett Drive, Room 102
Medford, Massachusetts 02155
781-393-2491*

MEMORANDUM

To: President and Members of the Medford City Council

From: Medford Election Commission

Date: July 29, 2026

Subject: Notice of Relocation of the Ward 4, Precinct 2 Polling Location Pursuant to Massachusetts General Laws Chapter 54, Section 24

Purpose

The purpose of this memorandum is to formally notify the Medford City Council of the relocation of the polling place serving **Ward 4, Precinct 2**, pursuant to **Massachusetts General Laws Chapter 54, Section 24**, due to construction affecting the current polling location.

Legal Authority

Massachusetts General Laws Chapter 54, Section 24 authorizes the local election authority to establish and designate polling places and, when circumstances require, to relocate polling places to protect the integrity of the electoral process and ensure that voting remains safe, orderly, and accessible.

The Medford Election Commission has reviewed the operational needs associated with the upcoming elections and has determined that the current polling location cannot adequately serve voters during the construction period.

Construction Impacts

The Commission has determined that continued use of the current polling location would present operational challenges, including but not limited to:

- Restricted public access due to ongoing construction activities.
- Potential safety concerns for voters and election workers.
- Reduced accessibility for elderly voters and persons with disabilities.
- Parking and traffic limitations.
- Possible interference with election operations and ballot security.

After evaluating alternative facilities, the Commission determined that the **Tufts Gantcher Center**, located at **161 College Avenue – Rear Entrance, Medford, Massachusetts 02155**, provides:

- Full accessibility consistent with the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA);
- Adequate parking;
- Safe pedestrian access.
- Appropriate space for election equipment and voter check-in.
- Improved traffic flow and emergency access.

New Polling Location

Effective for elections conducted during the construction period, voters residing in **Ward 4, Precinct 2** will vote at:

Tufts Gantcher Center
161 College Avenue – Rear Entrance
Medford, MA 02155

Public Notification Plan

The Election Commission will implement a comprehensive voter notification program that includes:

- Mailing notices to all affected registered voters.
- Updating the City's election website and polling place lookup tools.
- Posting notices at both the former and new polling locations.
- Social media announcements.
- Press releases to local media outlets.
- Directional signage on Election Day; and
- Coordination with Tufts University, the Police Department, and the Department of Public Works.

Request

The Election Commission respectfully requests that the City Council acknowledge receipt of this memorandum and assist in communicating the relocation to constituents. Thank you for your continued partnership in ensuring fair, secure, accessible, and transparent elections for the residents of Medford.

Respectfully submitted,

MEDFORD ELECTION COMMISSION



City of Medford

Election Commission
85 George P. Hassett Drive, Room 102
Medford, Massachusetts 02155
781-393-2491

CITY OF MEDFORD

COUNCIL PAPER

Offered by the Medford Election Commission

ORDER

Ordered: That the attached communication from the Medford Election Commission regarding the relocation of the **Ward 4, Precinct 2** polling place to the **Tufts Gantcher Center, 161 College Avenue – Rear Entrance, Medford, Massachusetts 02155**, pursuant to **Massachusetts General Laws Chapter 54, Section 24**, be received and placed on file.

Further Ordered: That the Medford City Council acknowledges receipt of the Commission's notice concerning the temporary polling place relocation necessitated by construction at the former polling location.

Further Ordered: That the City Clerk transmit a copy of this acknowledgment to the Medford Elections Commission.

Background

The Medford Election Commission has determined that construction activities affecting the existing polling location require the temporary relocation of the Ward 4, Precinct 2 polling place to ensure voter safety, accessibility, and the orderly administration of elections. The Tufts Gantcher Center has been identified as an accessible facility capable of accommodating election operations during the construction period.

The City Council recognizes the Commission's statutory authority under **Massachusetts General Laws Chapter 54, Section 24**, appreciates its proactive efforts to notify affected voters, and encourages residents of Ward 4, Precinct 2 to familiarize themselves with the new polling location before Election Day.

Presented to the Medford City Council on this 4th day of August, 2026.

The Medford City Council: _____

Attest:

City Clerk

Councilor Scarpelli motioned to Approve (seconded by Councilor Callahan) – Approved on a Roll call vote of Seven in favor, Zero opposed

26-144 - Medford Call for Election September 1, 2026



City of Medford

Election Commission
85 George P. Hassett Drive, Room 102
Medford, Massachusetts 02155
781-393-2491

Call for Election
2026 STATE PRIMARY
Tuesday, September 1, 2026

BE IT ORDERED: that the Elections Commission be and is hereby authorized and directed to notify and warn such of the inhabitants of the City of Medford, as were qualified by law to vote for candidates at our State Primary Election on Tuesday, September 1, 2026, to assemble at the polling places in their respective wards and precincts, then and there to give in their votes for:

SENATOR IN CONGRESS	For this Commonwealth
GOVERNOR	For this Commonwealth
LIEUTENANT GOVERNOR	For this Commonwealth
ATTORNEY GENERAL	For this Commonwealth
SECRETARY OF STATE	For this Commonwealth
TREASURER	For this Commonwealth
AUDITOR	For this Commonwealth
REPRESENTATIVE IN CONGRESS	5th Middlesex DISTRICT
COUNCILLOR	6th DISTRICT
SENATOR IN GENERAL COURT	2nd Middlesex DISTRICT
REPRESENTATIVE IN GENERAL COURT	23rd, 34th, 35th Middlesex
DISTRICT ATTORNEY	Northern DISTRICT
REGISTER OF PROBATE	Middlesex COUNTY

and the polls of said STATE PRIMARY ELECTION shall open at 7:00 A.M. and remain open until 8:00 P.M.

BE IT FURTHER ORDERED: that the following named polling places be, and they are hereby designated for use at the STATE PRIMARY ELECTION on September 1, 2026.

(The said polling places to be open at 7:00 A.M. to 8:00 P.M.)

Voting Precincts

Ward 1 Precinct 1	Andrew Middle School, 3000 Mystic Vly. Pkwy.
Ward 1 Precinct 2	Fire Fighters' Club, 340 Salem Street
Ward 2 Precinct 1	Roberts Elementary School, 35 Court Street
Ward 2 Precinct 2	Roberts Elementary School, 35 Court Street

Ward 3 Precinct 1	Medford American Legion, 321 Winthrop Street
Ward 3 Precinct 2	Temple Shalom, 475 Winthrop Street
Ward 4 Precinct 1	Tufts University, Gantcher Center Right Rear, 161 College Ave.
Ward 4 Precinct 2	Tufts University, Gantcher Center Right Rear, 161 College Ave.
Ward 5 Precinct 1	Missituk Elementary School, 37 Hicks Ave.
Ward 5 Precinct 2	Missituk Elementary School, 37 Hicks Ave.
Ward 6 Precinct 1	West Medford Fire Station, 26 Harvard Ave.
Ward 6 Precinct 2	Brooks School, 388 High Street
Ward 7 Precinct 1	Mystic Valley Towers, North Building Entrance
Ward 7 Precinct 2	McGlynn K-8 Public School, 3004 Mystic Valley Parkway
Ward 8 Precinct 1	Senior Center, 101 Riverside Avenue
Ward 8 Precinct 2	South Medford Fire Station, Zero Medford Street

In-person early voting for the September State Primary Election	Sat., Aug. 22 – 8:30am - 2:30pm
	Sun., Aug. 23 – 8:30am - 2:30pm
	Mon., Aug. 24 – 8:30am - 4:30pm
	Tues, Aug. 25 – 8:30am - 4:30pm
	Wed., Aug. 26 – 8:30am - 7:30pm
	Thur., Aug. 27 – 8:30am - 4:30pm
	Fri, Aug. 28 – 8:30am - 12:30pm

Vice President Lazzaro motioned to approve (seconded by Councilor Justin Tseng) – Approved on a Roll call vote of Seven in favor, Zero opposed

26-145 -Medford Election Warrant September 1, 2026

COMMONWEALTH OF MASSACHUSETTS
WILLIAM FRANCIS GALVIN
SECRETARY OF THE COMMONWEALTH
WARRANT FOR 2026 STATE PRIMARY

SS. To the Director of Elections of the City of Medford

GREETINGS:
In the name of the Commonwealth, you are hereby required to notify and warn the inhabitants of said city who are qualified to vote in Primaries to vote at:

Ward 1 (P1)	Andrews Middle School	3000 Mystic Valley Pkwy (Café
Ward 1 (P2)	Firefighter's Club	340 Salem Street
Ward 2 (P1)	Roberts Elementary School	Park St & Court St
Ward 2 (P2)	Roberts Elementary School	35 Court St
Ward 3 (P1)	American Legion	321 Winthrop St
Ward 3 (P2)	Temple Shalom	475 Winthrop St
Ward 4 (P1)	Tufts University, Gantcher Center Right Rear	161 College Ave
Ward 4 (P2)	Tufts University, Gantcher Center Right Rear	161 College Ave
Ward 5 (P1)	Missituk Elementary School	37 Hicks Ave
Ward 5 (P2)	Missituk Elementary School	37 Hicks Ave
Ward 6 (P1)	West Medford Fire Station	26 Harvard Ave
Ward 6 (P2 & P2A)	Brooks Elementary School	388 High St
Ward 7 (P1)	Mystic Valley Towers	North Building Entrance
Ward 7 (P2 & P2A)	McGlynn K-8 Public School	3004 Mystic Valley Pkwy
Ward 8 (P1)	Senior Center	101 Riverside Ave
Ward 8 (P2)	South Medford Fire Station	Zero Medford St

On **TUESDAY, THE FIRST DAY OF SEPTEMBER, 2026**, from 7:00 A.M. to 8:00 P.M. for the following purpose:

To cast their votes in the State Primaries for the candidates of political parties for the following offices:

SENATOR IN CONGRESS	For this Commonwealth
GOVERNOR	For this Commonwealth
LIEUTENANT GOVERNOR	For this Commonwealth
ATTORNEY GENERAL	For this Commonwealth
SECRETARY OF STATE	For this Commonwealth
TREASURER	For this Commonwealth
AUDITOR	For this Commonwealth
REPRESENTATIVE IN CONGRESS	5 th Middlesex DISTRICT
COUNCILLOR	6 th DISTRICT
SENATOR IN GENERAL COURT	2 nd Middlesex DISTRICT
REPRESENTATIVE IN GENERAL COURT	23 rd , 34 th , 35 th Middlesex DISTRICT
DISTRICT ATTORNEY	Northern DISTRICT
REGISTER OF PROBATE	Middlesex COUNTY

Hereof fail not and make return of this warrant with your doings thereon at the time and place of said voting.

COMMONWEALTH OF MASSACHUSETTS
WILLIAM FRANCIS GALVIN
SECRETARY OF THE COMMONWEALTH
WARRANT FOR 2026 STATE PRIMARY

Given under our hands this _____ day of _____, 2026.
(month)

President
City Council of Medford

Hand Delivered

_____, 2026.
Director of Elections (month and day)

Warrant must be posted by **August 25, 2026** (at least *seven days prior* to the **September 1, 2026** State Primary).

Vice President Lazzaro motioned to Approve (seconded by Councilor Tseng) –
Approved on a roll call vote of Seven in favor, Zero opposed

MOTIONS, ORDERS, AND RESOLUTIONS

26-024 - Resolution to Schedule Neighborhood Ward Meetings Hosted by City Council

Be it Resolved by the Medford City Council that the Council's Resident Services and Public Engagement Committee discuss a plan to schedule Neighborhood Ward Meetings hosted by the City Council in 2026 and 2027.

Councilor Mullane motioned to refer the paper back to Committee (seconded by Councilor Scarpelli) – Approved on a Roll call vote of Seven in Favor, Zero opposed

26-136 - Resolution to Demand Tufts Reinstate Graduate Worker Facing Retaliation and Retribution

Whereas, a Tufts University international graduate worker recently faced retaliation by her adviser for reporting that they required her to work a significant amount of hours as an unpaid teaching assistant, which violated her union contract. Later, the graduate worker was removed from her doctoral program; and,

Whereas, the worker and her union identified that there were multiple contract violations over the course of the year and the worker has experienced retaliation for protected union activity about her working conditions; and,

Whereas, after experiencing this retaliation, Tufts University informed the worker on June 24th that she was disenrolled from her doctoral program and transferred to the masters of science program, forcing her out of the university in August; and,

Whereas, after being forced out of the doctoral program that she intended to complete, her student visa is expected to expire in September 2026. This worker was not even given the opportunity to find a different adviser at Tufts, and she is not being given sufficient time to apply to other doctoral programs or conduct a proper job search; now, therefore:

Be it Resolved by the Medford City Council that we call on Tufts to immediately re-enroll this student in her doctoral program.

Be it Further Resolved that we call on Tufts to award this worker compensation for losing her summer stipend and losing her doctoral program enrollment after reporting bargaining contract violations, provide transitional support to move to a new lab to remain in the program, and cease any future tolerance of retribution for protected union activity – especially at a university that claims to be committed to advancing equity and justice.

Addressing the Council:

Genesis Perez 229 Main St
Simon Alcindor 44 Tainter St
Miccah Kessleman 499 Main St

President Bears motioned to Approve (seconded by Councilor Tseng) – Approved on a Roll call vote of Seven in favor, Zero opposed

26-137 - Resolution to Support Tufts Facilities Workers Bargaining for a Fair Contract

Whereas, the City of Medford and its residents share a strong interest in seeing through a good quality union contract between Tufts and its facilities workers who belong to SEIU 32BJ; and,

Whereas, these essential workers are employed as utility workers, as maintenance mechanics, in the grounds department, and in a variety of trades positions such carpenters, locksmiths, HVAC mechanics, plumbers, electricians, and more; and,

Whereas, as the largest private employer in Medford and Somerville, and a major Boston-area employer, Tufts University has a vitally important role in setting standards for all working people, particularly those to whom the University owes its buildings' conditioned functioning and its outstanding grounds; and,

Whereas, these proud 32BJ SEIU members' demands for a fair contract are reasonable: fair, family- sustaining wage increases, lower healthcare monthly healthcare premiums, protections for immigrant workers, union benefits and other richly deserved improvements; now, therefore:

Be it Resolved by the Medford City Council that we call on Tufts University to support the contract demands of Tufts facilities workers and to set an example of fair treatment and good labor relations for other area employers.

Addressing the Council:

Patrick Keith 64 Magoon Av
Simon Alcindor 44 Tainter St
Ilene Learner 3920 Mystic Valley Pkwy
Triana
Miccah Kessleman 499 Main St

President Bears motioned to Approve (seconded by Councilor Mullane) – Approved on a Roll call vote of Seven in favor, Zero opposed

COMMUNICATIONS FROM THE MAYOR

26-133 - Capital and General Stabilization Fund Appropriation Requests #2



MEDFORD, MASSACHUSETTS
MAYOR BREANNA LUNGO-KOEHN

July 9, 2026

Via Electronic Delivery

To the Honorable President and
Members of the Medford City Council
Medford City Hall
85 George P. Hassett Drive
Medford, MA 02155

Re: Capital and General Stabilization Fund Appropriation Requests

Dear President Bears and City Councilors:

I respectfully request and recommend that your Honorable Body approve appropriations from the:

1. Capital Stabilization Fund in the amount of Five Hundred Seventy-One Thousand Five Hundred Fifty Dollars and Zero Cents (\$571,550.00) on the following items:
 - a. Roberts Hot Water Tank Replacement for \$250,000;
 - b. Interactive Panels for Classrooms for \$180,000;
 - c. Address Facilities Conditions Assessment Projects at Schools for \$75,000;
 - d. Defibrillator Replacements at Schools for \$25,000;
 - e. Conceptual Building Study and Construction Cost Estimate for Oak Grove Building for \$24,550; and
 - f. Admins Server Replacement for \$17,000.

Given the appropriations made on June 23, 2026, the balance of the Capital Stabilization Fund before this vote is \$13,000,000.

2. General Stabilization Fund in the amount of Thirty-Five Thousand Dollars and Zero Cents (\$35,000.00) for an executive search and recruitment company to hire a new police chief.

The balance of the General Stabilization Fund before this vote is \$6,000,000. As the Council knows, Free Cash is not available this time of year, and where this is not a capital item, the only remaining source that would be acceptable would be General Stabilization Fund. Small amounts out of this fund will not impact the City's bond rating.

A School Department representative will be in attendance for items 1.a through d, DPW Commissioner Tim McGivern will be in attendance for item 1.e, IT Director Richard Lane will

be in attendance for item 1.f and Human Resources Director Lisa Crowley and Police Chief Jack Buckley will be in attendance for item 2.

Thank you for your kind attention to these matters.

Respectfully submitted,


Breanna Lungo-KoeHN
Mayor

Addressing the Council:

Lisa Crowley Director of Human Resources
Paul Buckley Chief of Police

Councilor Scarpelli motioned to Table (seconded by Councilor Mullane) – Failed on a Three in Favor, Four opposed (Callhan, Leming, Tseng and Lazzaro)

President Bears motioned to Table (seconded by Councilor Callahan) – Approved on a Roll call vote of Five in Favor, Two opposed (Leming and Lazzaro)

26-139 - Board and Commission Appointments

Zoning Board of Appeals

- Chris D'Aveta
- Reapplication to the ZBA
- 3 years - expiring on 3-31-2029

Water & Sewer Commission

- Lucica Hiller
- 3 years • 03/31/2029

Medford Arts Council (MAC) - 2

- Irene Ros and Swabarna Mukherjee
- 3 years • 12/01/2029

Councilor Scarpelli Motioned to Approve (seconded by Councilor Tseng) – Approved on a Roll call vote of Seven in favor, Zero opposed

26-140 - Community Preservation Committee Appropriation Request - Playstead Park Digital Scoreboard Contingency and Osgood House Gutter/Storm Window Restoration



**MEDFORD, MASSACHUSETTS
MAYOR BREANNA LUNGO-KOEHN**

July 30, 2026

Via Electronic Delivery

To the Honorable President and
Members of the Medford City Council
Medford City Hall
Medford, MA 02155

Re: FY27 CPA Appropriation Requests – Playstead Park Digital Scoreboard Contingency and Osgood House Gutter + Storm Window Restoration

Dear President Bears and City Councilors:

On behalf of the Community Preservation Committee, I respectfully request and recommend that your Honorable Body approve the following FY27 recommendations of the Community Preservation Committee:

Requesting the appropriation of \$32,000.00 from the CPA Open Space Reserve to Medford High School Athletics Division, to provide additional contingency funds for the Playstead Park Digital Baseball Scoreboard; and

Requesting the appropriation of \$10,000.00 from the CPA Historic Preservation Reserve to Unitarian Universalist Church of Medford, to fund the Osgood House Gutter + Storm Window Restoration project.

The project will be tracked in the Community Preservation Fund. The CPC recommendation letters are attached and incorporated. Community Preservation Act Manager Theresa Dupont will be in attendance to address the Council.

Thank you for your consideration.

Respectfully submitted,


Breanna Lungo-KoeHN
Mayor

Enclosure

Councilor Scarpelli motioned to Approve (seconded by Councilor Mullane) – Approved on a roll call vote of Seven in favor, Zero opposed

26-141 - Unpaid Bill of Previous Fiscal Year



**MEDFORD, MASSACHUSETTS
MAYOR BREANNA LUNGO-KOEHN**

July 30, 2026

Via Electronic Delivery

To The Honorable President and
Members of the Medford City Council
Medford City Hall
Medford, MA 02155

Re: Unpaid Bill of Previous Fiscal Year

Dear President Bears and City Councilors:

I respectfully request and recommend that your Honorable Body approve the expenditure of fiscal year 2027 building departmental appropriations in the amount of One Thousand, Five Hundred Dollars and Zero Cents (\$1,500.00) for the payment of prior fiscal years' bill to Citizenserve, the City's permitting platform, in accordance with M.G.L. c. 44, §64, as detailed in the enclosed invoice.

Finance Director/Auditor Bob Dickinson will be in attendance.

Respectfully submitted,


Breanna Lungo-Koehn

Mayor

Enclosure

Addressing the Council:

Bob Dickinson Finance Director

Vice President Lazzaro motioned to Approve (seconded by Councilor Callahan) –
Approved on a Roll call vote of Seven in favor, Zero opposed

26-142 - Supplemental Appropriation for the Fiscal Year 2027



July 30, 2026

Via Electronic Delivery
To the Honorable President and
Members of the Medford City Council
Medford City Hall
85 George P. Hassett Drive
Medford, MA 02155

Re: Supplemental Appropriation for the Fiscal Year 2027

Dear President Bears and Members of the City Council:

I respectfully request and recommend that your Honorable Body approves the following supplemental appropriation for Fiscal Year 2027, to restore the Law Department budget, which was originally proposed in a June 4, 2026 submission to the City Council.

	Mayor Proposed 6/4/26	City Council Cut on 6/23/26
Salaries	\$230,866.60	\$182,576.33
Ordinary	\$298,700.00	\$242,500.00
Total	\$529,566.60	\$425,076.33

And to meet this appropriation, the sum of Four Hundred Twenty-Five Thousand Seventy-Six Dollars and Thirty-Three Cents (\$425,076.33) be raised and appropriated from the Fiscal Year 2026 tax levy.

Over the past several weeks, we have made a thoughtful effort to engage with the Council on this appropriation as well as the provisions of legal documents responsive to your records requests. On May 13th, we responded to the Council's public records request, noting that Item (a) alone, of the nine requested items, would take an estimated 395 hours to review just email records.

On June 16th, we supplied the Council with 130 pages of City-side settlements and School-side settlements between 2020 and the Council's request.

On June 23rd, we provided the spending detail in the Fire Department Professional Services line as well as an outline of other legal expenditures incurred by the City in Fiscal Year 2026 budget. You may recall, I wrote to the full Council on June 3rd offering to discuss the most effective process for providing those materials. My Chief of Staff also requested at both the June 9th and June 23rd Council meetings that the Council designate a member to work with our office on this matter. We unfortunately have yet to receive a response.

Most recently, on July 23rd, we supplied an updated breakdown of Medford's FY26 budget legal spending compared to other communities and on the same date, I emailed the Council President asking how we can reach an understanding so that my office could begin working a grant agreement to help fund Medford Family Network, begin the recruitment process for a new arts liaison position, and other budget priorities. I have not heard back on this request as of yet.

My administration has consistently sought to engage with the Council in a collaborative and transparent manner, and we remain committed to doing so. However, our repeated requests for coordination and communication with the Council have thus far gone unanswered. It is important that we receive direction and feedback from the Council collectively, or at least from a majority of its members, so that we can be confident we are proceeding in accordance with the Council's expectations and are not expending City staff time and resources pursuing work that may ultimately prove unnecessary or incomplete.

Thank you for your kind attention to this matter.

Sincerely,


Breanna Lungo-KoeHN
Mayor

Councilor Tseng motioned to Amend the Appropriation paper to cut 382,586.70 from the Appropriation and approve 42,507.63 one-month funding (seconded by Councilor Scarpelli) – Approved on a Roll call vote of Seven in favor, Zero opposed

26-142B - Council Response to Paper 26-142

Offered by President Bears
Motion to Approve: Councilor Tseng
Approved Unanimously

Whereas, the Medford City Council unanimously approved Resolution 26-043 on February 24, 2026 requesting a comprehensive litigation report from the City Administration regarding the significant increase in legal claims against the City of Medford since January

2020 and the financial cost of the City Administration's decisions regarding litigation strategy and employee relations to the city and its residents; and,

Whereas, the Medford City Council unanimously approved Resolution 26-077 on April 28, 2026 to file a Public Records Request pursuant to state law due to the City Administration's lack of response to the prior request; and,

Whereas, the Medford City Council took numerous votes and councilors provided clarity and guidance to the City Administration at dozens of public City Council meetings since February 2026 regarding the information requested in the above resolutions; and,

Whereas, the Medford City Council has only received partial and significantly delayed responses from the City Administration, including information never requested by the Council; and,

Whereas, the Medford City Council was forced to reduce the FY27 Law Department budget due to lack of information about past legal expenses and planned FY27 legal expenses in order to exercise basic oversight and transparency regarding the FY27 City Budget; and,

Whereas, the City Administration has made repeated statements that they are not capable of meeting these requests even after repeated clarifications by the Council; and,

Whereas, the Medford City Council received a document today, August 4, 2026, summarizing KP Law expenditures since January 2020 with a total sum of \$2.4 million; and,

Whereas, the Chief of Staff informed the City Council by email that she is not able to attend tonight's meeting due to a prior commitment and requested that the Council refer any additional questions to the Mayor and Chief of Staff; now, therefore:

Be it Resolved by the Medford City Council that we request the following from the City Administration:

1. A written response to Resolution 26-043 with the status of each requested item in the Comprehensive Litigation Report and Quarterly Litigation Status Report, including an explanation of what efforts have been made to respond to each request and why the City Administration cannot provide the requested information, if necessary. This explanation may also include any efforts made to respond to the Public Records Request authorized by the Council in Resolution 26-077.
2. A written response to Resolution 26-043's request for an independent review of the City's litigation costs, practices, and risk management procedures.
3. A categorization of the August 4, 2026 list of KP Law expenditures into the following categories:
 - i. Collective bargaining negotiation expenses
 - ii. Employee litigation, arbitration, grievance, or other settlement-related expenses
 - iii. Legal review of ordinances or board and commission proceedings
 - iv. Non-employee claims and litigation (e.g. vehicle or sewer claims)
 - v. Provision of legal guidance to city staff regarding administrative actions
 - vi. Other legal work
4. A similar report and categorization of expenditures for any other outside legal services provided by firms other than KP Law since 2020.
5. A financial summary of all settlements or judgments against the city for claims over \$10,000 since 2020, including the amount paid by the city for each claim and the source of funds used to make payment.

6. A list and total estimated cost of all budgeted legal expenses for the FY27 city budget in department budgets other than the Law Department.
7. An update on the hiring of a City Solicitor and when the job will be posted.

Be it Further Resolved that the Medford City Council hopes that this further written clarification of its numerous and repeated requests for information since February 2026 will provide the City Administration with appropriate guidance to meet these requests and provide a transparent and full accounting of the city's legal expenses since 2020 to the residents of Medford.

Be it Further Resolved that this resolution be submitted to the City Administration immediately and the text be placed on the September 15, 2026 City Council Regular Meeting Agenda as Paper 26-142B along with any written responses received from the City Administration by September 10.

Addressing the Council:

Nick Gurleo
Andrew Castignetti
Simon Alcindor
Miccah Kessleman

Councilor Tseng motioned to take up B-Paper as amended by Councilor Scarpelli (seconded by Councilor Scarpelli) - Approved on a roll call vote of Seven in Favor, Zero opposed

Councilor Leming motioned to take 26-054, 26-124 and 26-063 off the Table (seconded by Pres Bears) _ Approved on a Roll call vote of Seven in Favor, Zero opposed

UNFINISHED BUSINESS

25-054 - Chapter 10, Article VIII - Proposed Vacant Building Ordinance

CHAPTER 94 - Sec 94-7.5 is hereby removed.

CHAPTER 10 – BUILDINGS AND BUILDING REGULATIONS

ARTICLE VIII. - Vacant and foreclosing properties.

“The Full text of the Ordinance can be found Online”

Vice President Lazzaro motioned to Severe changes 4, 6, 7 from the amendments (seconded by Councilor Tseng) – Approved on a Roll Call vote of Four in favor, Three opposed (Mullane, Scarpelli, Bears)

Councilor Tseng motioned to Adopt changes 4, 6 and 7 (seconded by Vice President Lazzaro) – Approved on a Roll call vote of Four in favor, Three opposed (Callahan, Leming and Lazzaro)

Councilor Leming motioned to Approve ordinance as Amended to be ordained (seconded by Councilor Tseng) – Approved on a Roll call vote of Seven in favor, Zero opposed

26-124 - Personnel Ordinance Amendments - Director and Assistant Director of Health and Human Services



MEDFORD, MASSACHUSETTS
MAYOR BREANNA LUNGO-KOEHN

June 16, 2026

Via Electronic Delivery

To the Honorable President and
Members of the Medford City Council
Medford City Hall
85 George P. Hassett Drive
Medford, MA 02155

Re: Personnel Ordinance Amendments

Dear President Bears and City Councilors:

I respectfully request and recommend that your Honorable Body approve the following amendments to the Revised Ordinances Chapter 66 entitled "Personnel," Article II entitled "Reserved" (the city's "Classification and Compensation Plan)," formerly included as Art. II §§, 66-31—66-40, by adopting the following changes, effective July 1, 2026:

Amendment A

The language of "CAF-12" shall be amended to remove "Prevention & Outreach Manager" and the language of "CAF-13" shall be amended to include the following position:

"Assistant Health and Human Services Director"

Amendment B

The language of "CAF-19" shall be amended to remove "Director of Public Health" and replace it with the following position:

"Director of Health and Human Services"

Director of Public Health MaryAnn O'Connor will be available to speak on this request.

Respectfully submitted,


Breanna Lungo-Koehn
Mayor

Councilor Callahan motioned to Approve (seconded by Councilor Tseng) – Approved on a Roll call vote of Seven in favor, Zero opposed

26-063 - Resolution to Update the Ordinance Establishing the Medford Commission for Persons with Disabilities



Medford City Council
Medford, Massachusetts

MEETING DATE	SPONSORED BY
July 14, 2026	Matt Leming, City Councilor
AGENDA ITEM	
26-063 - Resolution to Update the Ordinance Establishing the Medford Commission for Persons with Disabilities	
FULL TEXT AND DESCRIPTION	
Whereas, the Medford Commissions for Persons with Disabilities approved a proposed ordinance change that would remove exclusionary language concerning drug use, modernize terminology throughout the language of the ordinance, and clarify and positively define the commission's role; now, therefore: Be it Resolved by the Medford City Council that we update the Ordinance Establishing the Medford Commission for Persons with Disabilities	
RECOMMENDATION	
FISCAL IMPACT	
ATTACHMENTS	
1. Commission for Persons with Disabilities Ordinance 7.14.26	

“Full text of the Ordinance can be found online”

Vice President Lazzaro motioned to Approve (seconded by Councilor Leming) -
Approved on a Roll call vote of Seven in favor, Zero opposed

ADJOURNMENT

Councilor Scarpelli motioned to Adjourn (seconded by Councilor Tseng) - Approved by
Roll call vote Six in favor, Zero opposed and one absent (Leming)

Respectfully Submitted

Richard Eliseo Jr
Acting City Clerk

